

GALILEAN MOON

Callisto

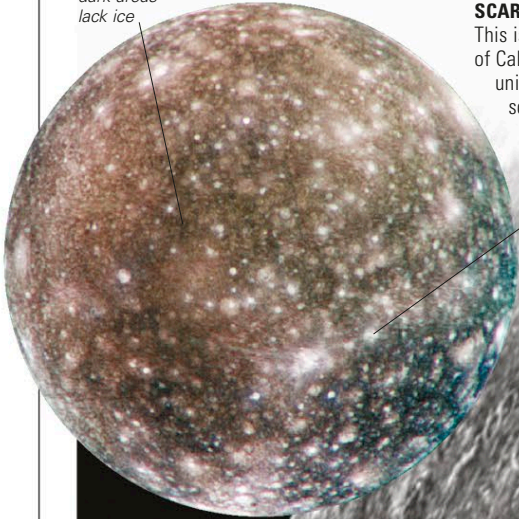
DISTANCE FROM JUPITER 1.17 million miles (1.88 million km)

ORBITAL PERIOD 16.69 Earth days

DIAMETER 2,994 miles (4,821 km)

The most distant, second-largest, and darkest of the Galilean moons, Callisto is still brighter than Earth's Moon since its surface contains ice that reflects sunlight. Callisto has undergone little internal change since its formation. Its original mix of rock and ice is only partly differentiated, so the moon is rockier toward its center and icier

dark areas lack ice



ice on crater rim and floor shines brightly

TINDR CRATER

The partial collapse of the rim of this 47-mile (76-km) wide crater and its pitted floor is probably the result of erosion by ice.



toward its crust. The surface, scarred by craters and multiringed structures created by meteorite impacts, bears few signs of geological activity. Callisto does not appear to have been shaped by plate tectonics or cryovolcanism, where ice behaves like volcanic lava, although the ice has eroded the rock in places, causing crater rims to be worn away and sometimes collapse.

SCARRED SURFACE

This is the only complete global color image of Callisto obtained by Galileo. The surface is uniformly cratered, and the bright impact scars are easily visible against its otherwise dark, smooth surface.



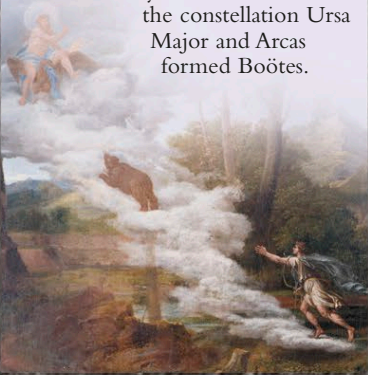
VALHALLA REGION

This photograph of part of the Valhalla Basin, lit by sunlight streaming in from the left, shows a 6-mile (10-km) wide fault scarp, part of Valhalla's ring system. The smallest craters visible are about 510 ft (155 m) across.

MYTHS AND STORIES

CALLISTO

Callisto was a beautiful follower of the huntress Artemis, who was seduced by Zeus and bore him a son. According to one myth, Zeus's jealous wife, Hera, turned Callisto into a bear. One day, Callisto came across her son, Arcas, now grown. Fearful for his life, Arcas was only stopped from killing Callisto by Zeus, who raised a whirlwind that carried the pair up into the sky. Callisto became the constellation Ursa Major and Arcas formed Boötes.



MULTIRING BASIN

The multiringed Valhalla Basin dominates Callisto's surface. The bright, ice-covered central zone is about 370 miles (600 km) across. It is surrounded by rings, which are troughs about 30 miles (50 km) apart.